

OPEN SOURCE · CANADA (US EXPERIMENTAL) · RUNS ON YOUR MACHINE

# taxjson

Your broker's CSV in. Schedule 3 out. Capital gains, dividends and the superficial-loss rule computed the way the CRA defines them — across every account you own — with every rule citing its source.

```
bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://taxjson.com/install.sh)"
```

[taxjson.com](https://taxjson.com) · [github.com/taxjson/taxjson](https://github.com/taxjson/taxjson) · MIT

## THE PROBLEM

# The slip your broker files is not your cost basis

A T5008 reports proceeds per account. The Income Tax Act taxes you on **one average cost per security across all your accounts**, denies losses when any affiliated account — your RRSP included — bought the same thing within 30 days, and folds option premiums, splits, spin-offs and return of capital into that cost. Nobody's statement does that math for you.

### Cross-account pooling

s.47: one ACB pool per identical property. A US listing and its TSX listing are the same pool; a CDR is not.

### Superficial losses

s.54 / s.40(2)(g): a loss is denied if you *or an affiliated person* bought within  $\pm 30$  days and still holds. Denied into an RRSP, it is gone for good.

### Everything that moves cost

Assignments (IT-479R), splits, spin-offs (s. 86.1), mergers with elections, ROC, reinvested distributions — in the right order, on the settlement date.

**Spreadsheets get the easy 90% right. The other 10% is where reassessments come from.**

## WHAT IT DOES

# Three steps, all on disk

### inputs/

Broker CSV exports per account: IBKR, Questrade, RBC, Webull, Kraken, Coinbase — plus plain-text .txt for anything else



### taxjson run

Parse · convert at the Bank of Canada rate per settlement date · pool identical securities · corporate actions with elections · superficial-loss pass across taxable and registered accounts



### reports/

Per-account summaries, the wash radar, harvest candidates, T1135, a tax estimate, Schedule 3 / Form 8949 rows — and the broker cross-check

### One config file

`taxjson.toml` : year, country, province, base currency, one section per account with its type (taxable / sheltered) and the broker positions files to check against.

### Row accounting

Every parser accounts for every row it reads. Rows it recognises but does not translate are counted and named — never silently dropped.

### Traceable numbers

`taxjson audit` recomputes every disposition from the parsed broker row through FX, ACB and the wash determination, and ties it out against the reports.

RULES WITH RECEIPTS

# Every computation names its source

| RULE                 | WHAT TAXJSON DOES                                                                                                                                                                                                   | SOURCE                                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Identical properties | One average-cost pool per security across accounts; cross-listings merged, CDRs kept apart                                                                                                                          | s.47(1); IT-387R2; T4037                       |
| Superficial loss     | Denied to the extent an affiliated account acquired in the 61-day window and still holds; the RRSP/TFSA is affiliated; denied-into-plan is permanent                                                                | s.54, s.40(2)(g)(i), s.53(1)(f), s.251.1(1)(g) |
| Disposition date     | Settlement date, including at year end                                                                                                                                                                              | T4037                                          |
| Foreign currency     | Bank of Canada rate on each settlement date, never an annual average                                                                                                                                                | Folio S5-F4-C1                                 |
| Options              | A written option's premium is a gain in the year written; a buy-back is a loss in its own year; an assignment folds the premium into the shares. <code>option-boundary</code> says when a filed year needs a T1-ADJ | s.49(1)–(4); IT-479R                           |
| Corporate actions    | Splits, spin-offs, mergers with the rollover election recorded and a filing reminder at every run; ROC reduces ACB                                                                                                  | s.86.1, s.85.1, s.53(2)(h)                     |
| US (experimental)    | FIFO, §1091 wash sales with basis and holding-period carry, IRA repurchases permanent, Form 8949 codes                                                                                                              | §1091, Reg. 1.1091-1, Rev. Rul. 2008-5         |

The full map — including what is deliberately *not* modelled and the provision it skips — is REFERENCES.md. A rule that disagrees with its source is a bug; that is the most useful issue the project can receive.

## WORKED EXAMPLE

# A loss you cannot claim

### What happened

The margin account sells 400 shares at a loss on February 3. On February 10 the RRSP buys 200 of the same stock, and still holds them on March 5.

### What the slip says

A capital loss on 400 shares. The spreadsheet agrees.

### What the Act says

An affiliated person acquired 200 identical shares inside the 61-day window and still owns them at its end: the loss on those 200 is superficial (s.54). The ACB bump goes to the RRSP — where it is worthless. Permanently denied. Shares the RRSP held before the window would not have counted.

**NOTE:** superficial loss – 200 sh denied (permanently: replacement property held in rrsp)  
loss sale 2026-02-03 · trigger lot 2026-02-10 (rrsp) · window end 2026-03-05

**Only a tool that sees every account at once can get this right. That is the whole design.**

# Checked against the one thing that cannot lie

Internal reports can all agree and still be wrong. `taxjson sanity` compares the positions the books say you hold with the positions your broker's own export says you hold, account by account. Any difference is a trade that has not reached the CSV yet, or a booking problem — there is no third kind.

## 2,100+ tests

Every fix lands with a regression test that failed before it. No mocks for tax math.

## Three property fuzzers

Conservation of gains under the wash rule, custody-transfer netting, split-during-settlement books — thousands of random ledgers per run.

## Eight audit rounds

Adversarial reviews, statutory scenarios by hand, parser coverage on real exports, a pre-release security audit. Every finding reproduced, fixed, pinned.

## Published limits

KNOWN\_ISSUES.md lists what is out of scope and what to do by hand, with the citation.

## COMMANDS

# One pipeline, a few dozen views on it

### Build the books

- `init` scaffold a project
- `fetch` Questrade / IBKR activity
- `run` the whole pipeline + broker check
- `elect` corporate-action elections

### Read the numbers

- `sum` the year, by account
- `list` / `shares` positions
- `events` / `trades` / `divs` the rows
- `audit` the justification

### Before you trade

- `wash-radar` safe-to-sell dates
- `sell-check` / `buy-check`
- `harvest` losses worth taking
- `scan` tax-efficiency lint

### Before you file

- `checklist` every step, auto-detected
- `form-export` Schedule 3 / 8949
- `reconcile-slips` / `t1135` / `carryover`
- `option-boundary` / `close-year`

Every command takes `--help`; most take `--json`. `taxjson redact` strips identifiers from a real export so it can be shared as a parser sample.

# Nothing personal leaves the machine

## Local by construction

Parsing, pooling and the wash pass run on your computer. The pipeline's only network calls are FX rates (Bank of Canada; Yahoo before 2017) and crypto prices for unpriced rows — both switchable off with `TAXJSON_OFFLINE=1`. SECURITY.md lists every egress.

## No credentials stored

Broker fetch uses your own token file; it is never written into a project or sent anywhere but that broker.

## The project guards itself

A personal-data scan runs in every gate and as the pre-push hook, fails closed, and reads a private denylist kept outside the repository. Redacted exports keep every row shape and drop the identifiers `redact` recognises — review before sharing.

**Zero runtime dependencies in the core. A tax tool has to be trustworthy before it is clever.**

## SCOPE

# Canada is the product. The US engine is a draft.

### Canada — supported

Average-cost ACB, superficial-loss rule across accounts, settlement-date timing, options, corporate actions with elections, T1135, Schedule 3, instalments and a marginal-rate estimate with provincial tables. Validated against two years of real multi-account books and the brokers' positions.

### US — experimental

FIFO, §1091 wash sales, short/long-term, Form 8949 codes and a TXF export. Implemented and unit-tested, never validated on a real account. It says so at every run. Real US exports — redacted — are the way to change that.

**Honest labelling costs nothing. A tax tool that overclaims loses the only thing it has.**

BROKERS

# Reads the exports you already have

| BROKER               | FORMAT                                            | NOTES                                                                           |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Interactive Brokers  | Activity / Flex statement CSV                     | Trades, options, corporate actions, transfers, fees, dividends; Flex auto-fetch |
| Questrade            | Activity CSV                                      | Trades, DRIP, cash-in-lieu, transfers; REST auto-fetch and live positions       |
| RBC Direct Investing | Activity export                                   | Trades, dividends with withholding                                              |
| Webull               | Account statement CSV                             | Trades and options                                                              |
| Kraken · Coinbase    | Ledgers / transaction history                     | Trades, rewards, sends and withdrawals as custody evidence                      |
| Anything else        | <code>.tt</code> plain text · generic CSV mapping | Ten-line files a human can write and read                                       |

Help wanted: Wealthsimple, TD Direct, BMO InvestorLine, CIBC Investor's Edge, Scotia iTRADE, National Bank Direct, Qtrade, Desjardins. A parser is an afternoon's work given one real export — `taxjson redact` makes sharing one safe.

## INSTALL

# Your first books in ten minutes

```
bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://taxjson.com/install.sh)"
```

Installs the latest release into its own Python environment and links `taxjson` onto your PATH. Needs git and Python 3.9+, nothing else. Re-run to upgrade.

```
mkdir -p ~/taxes/2026 && cd ~/taxes/2026
taxjson init --country canada      # writes taxjson.toml and inputs/
# drop broker CSVs into inputs/margin/, inputs/rrsp/, ...
taxjson run                        # books, reports, wash pass, broker check
taxjson sum                       # the realized-gains summary
taxjson wash-radar                 # "can I sell this at a loss today?"
```

WHERE IT GOES

# Roadmap

## More Canadian brokers

Driven by redacted real exports from users. One parser per afternoon, each with the row-accounting contract.

## Rules retail investors hit

Non-eligible dividends and T3 box splits, DRIP fractions, the s.39(4) election, CNIL — whichever real exports show first.

## US validation

The engine exists; it needs a real account. The label comes off when the numbers have been checked against one.

## 1.0

PyPI, a frozen CLI, and the interchange contract with portfolio tools written down.

[taxjson.com](https://taxjson.com) · [github.com/taxjson/taxjson](https://github.com/taxjson/taxjson) · MIT · not tax advice — a calculator that shows its work.